

One organization, one story — how Co-Labr compares

Where Co-Labr sits next to the tools missionaries use today — Mailchimp and Epistle — and what changes when the *whole organization* tells its story on one platform.

Mailchimp is a general marketing tool that missionaries bend into a newsletter sender. **Epistle** is a genuinely good app built for the individual missionary. **Co-Labr starts from a different question:** what if every missionary and national staff member published from one branded home — where supporters discover the wider ministry, gifts route correctly through the organization, and leadership can actually see how their people are doing?

	MAILCHIMP	EPISTLE	CO-LABR
Built for	Businesses sending marketing email; missionaries adapt it.	The individual missionary — "by missionaries, for missionaries."	The whole organization. Every missionary and national staff member publishes on one platform, under the organization's own brand, with country-level co-branded pages.
ORG IMPACT One shared home instead of hundreds of disconnected accounts — supporters, staff, and leadership all meet in the same place.			
Writing an update	Generic campaign builder; every sender designs their own layout from marketing templates.	Quick social-style posts with photos and videos; posts bundle automatically into digest emails.	A guided ministry composer: banner, photos, video, key numbers, quotes, prayer & praise, giving, and a personal sign-off. Banner and sign-off are always present, with live preview, reusable templates, and simple text formatting.
ORG IMPACT Every update reads like ministry, not marketing — and the least design-gifted staff member still publishes something beautiful.			
Branding	Whatever each person builds; brand consistency depends on individual effort.	Epistle's own look and feel, with the missionary's content inside it.	The organization's real brand, enforced by design: block colors come from the organization's own brand palette, country pages carry national branding, and even the "most-read" highlight wears the brand color.
ORG IMPACT Hundreds of communicators, one visual identity — without a communications team policing every send.			
Supporter experience	One-size email blasts. The supporter's only lever is unsubscribe — and it's final.	Partners choose daily, weekly, or monthly digests and can like, pray, and comment from the email.	Every email carries a personal preferences link: full email, quick link, monthly summary, or site-only. New supporters get a warm welcome flow; anyone leaving is gently offered a lighter option first.
ORG IMPACT Fewer supporters lost at the exit door — people leave mailing lists, not relationships, and Co-Labr gives them somewhere softer to land.			
Discovering the wider ministry	None — each audience is a silo.	A partner follows their missionary; the wider organization stays invisible.	Cross-pollination is the point: a "team picks" rail on every wall, stories featured across pages with permission, the President's Monthly archive, and most-read rankings that surface the best storytelling.

ORG IMPACT A supporter who came for one family meets the whole movement — and prayer, awareness, and giving widen with them.

Giving	None built in — link out and hope.	Partners can give through the platform.	Giving routes through the organization: every page's Give button points to the organization's designated fund for that missionary's ministry — never to an individual.
---------------	------------------------------------	---	---

ORG IMPACT Gifts stay inside the organization's own designation, receipting, and accountability systems from day one.

Member care	Open and click rates.	Engagement analytics — who opens, likes, prays, comments.	Care Radar: AI reads across everyone's updates for hard news, big changes, new babies, and losses; sends leadership a daily care digest; flags staff who've gone quiet for 60+ days; and tracks each person's trajectory across recent updates.
--------------------	-----------------------	---	--

ORG IMPACT Leadership learns who needs a phone call this week — from what staff actually wrote, not from open rates. No other tool in this space does this.

Helping writers improve	Campaign stats: opens, clicks.	Detailed engagement reporting and an activity feed.	Coaching, not just counting: read-through insights, title studies drawn from real open data, most-read rankings, and AI writing insights for each page.
--------------------------------	--------------------------------	---	--

ORG IMPACT The whole team's storytelling gets better over time — and great stories get seen and imitated.

Adding your people	CSV imports and embedded signup forms; you manage the list mechanics yourself.	Invite partners; the app requests their communication preferences.	A shepherded migration: personal invite letters with one-click private links, CSV import with plain-language export instructions, and a "Your people" panel showing exactly who's following, who's deciding, and who declined.
---------------------------	--	--	---

ORG IMPACT Moving hundreds of staff off old lists becomes a guided process each missionary can do alone in an afternoon.

Data & GDPR	Supporter data lives inside Intuit's marketing ecosystem.	Strong security posture: encryption, private posts, invisible mode for sensitive contexts.	The organization's data, under its control: each organization's list is fully isolated from every other; supporters get one-click preference changes and full self-serve erasure; US storage is disclosed and covered by EU-approved safeguards.
------------------------	---	--	---

ORG IMPACT The organization can answer any supporter's GDPR question — or erasure request — in seconds, not committee meetings.

Cost shape	Per-missionary subscriptions that grow with each contact list — typically \$20–100+/month each.	\$14/month per missionary (about \$168/year each; 300 staff ≈ \$50,000/year).	One organizational platform — a single relationship covering every staff member, instead of hundreds of individual subscriptions. (Organizational pricing to be defined.)
-------------------	---	---	--

ORG IMPACT Predictable, budgetable, org-level cost — and no staff member priced out of communicating well.

The wider landscape — at a glance

Beyond Mailchimp and Epistle, missionaries assemble their communication from a patchwork of tools. Each is good at its piece; none serves the organization. A typical missionary today runs three or four of these at once.

TOOL	WHAT IT IS	WHAT IT DOES WELL	WHERE IT STOPS — AND WHERE CO-LABR PICKS UP
Prayvine	Prayer-request platform, free to missionaries.	Sending prayer needs to partners and gathering their responses; warm, focused, simple.	Prayer only — no full updates, no giving, no organization. Co-Labr builds prayer & praise into every update, alongside the whole story.
prayerletters.com	Printed prayer-letter printing & mailing service (1,000+ missionaries).	Physical letters, printed, stuffed, and mailed — beloved by older supporters who want paper.	Print only; the missionary still writes and manages the list elsewhere. A natural future partner: an update composed in Co-Labr could one day go out as a printed letter too.
TntConnect, Karani, DonorElf (MPDX is now Cru-only)	Support-raising CRMs — donor and pledge tracking.	Knowing who gives, who pledged, who to thank; the financial backbone of personal support raising.	They keep the <i>list</i> but don't tell the <i>story</i> — updates still go out through Mailchimp or print. Co-Labr is the storytelling half these tools always outsourced.
Facebook, Instagram, WhatsApp	Social channels used informally for ministry updates.	Free, immediate, where some supporters already are.	The algorithm decides who sees what, the platform owns the audience, and nothing routes to prayer or giving. Co-Labr gives the org its own wall — with the list owned, not rented.

The pattern across all of them: every tool on this page — and both tools in the matrix above — serves the *individual* missionary. A typical staff member today runs a CRM + Mailchimp + a giving link + maybe a print service: four tools, four silos, no shared brand, and leadership sees none of it. Co-Labr is the first platform in this space built for the organization.

Mailchimp, Epistle, and the wider-landscape tools are summarized from their public websites as of August 2026 (epistle.org, mailchimp.com, prayvine.com, prayerletters.com, tntware.com); all are good tools, compared here fairly and in good faith — corrections welcome. Co-Labr is an app by Tov-ell LLC. This is a living document: add rows as features ship, and refine wording as we learn how to tell it.